
Project Proposal

for

sous chef

Version 1.0 approved

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The Sued Chefs

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Revision History

Name	Date	Reason For Changes	Version

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

Sous Chef is a recipe management software designed to hold cookbook-like information such as ingredients and steps to complete a recipe as well as general information and categorization for recipes. Sous Chef will allow cooks to store notes and iterate upon recipes that they store as well as share their recipes with others. The system may also expand to meal planning and ingredient inventory tracking in time.

1.2 Project Scope

This software is relatively small and ideally meant to be self hosted by the end user. We will be using ASP.NET and Blazor with Entity Framework to simplify the creation of an integrated server and frontend software that will interact with a backend PostgreSQL database. Through the use of these existing tools we estimate that we should be able to implement the core product features in the coming weeks as listed below. We may integrate a component library for Blazor as our understanding of needs evolves.

1.3 References

Learn more about our resources:

- ASP.NET Core <https://dotnet.microsoft.com/en-us/apps/aspnet>
- Blazor <https://dotnet.microsoft.com/en-us/apps/aspnet/web-apps/blazor>
- Entity Framework <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/aspnet/entity-framework>
- PostgreSQL <https://www.postgresql.org/>

2. Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

Many recipe manager softwares exist but very few have the ability to be self hosted and many are advertising plagued and cost prohibitive to make use of. The goals behind Sous Chef are to create a by-default self hosted solution to keep end users in full control of their data and allow for customization to fit each users specific needs. While it would be possible to expand into paid cloud services to support Sous Chef, it's important that the project be simple and reliable for individuals. Sous Chef will be primarily geared towards users of a free and open source software and tech-savvy households who want a better handle on their recipe management and meal planning.

2.2 Product Features

Core features include:

- Ability to store and edit recipes including description, instructions, ingredient list, and required equipment list.

- Ability to take notes on recipes that can be shared
- Ability for users to have private, public, or specifically shared recipes and folders
- Ability for users to view the revision of history of their recipe and take notes on changes they have made
- Ability to tag, categorize, and organize meals

Additional features that are stretch goals include:

- Meal planning and scheduling component
- Ingredient inventory component
- "Pantry meals" the ability to provide a list of ingredients and have Sous Chef provide the user with a list of recipes they can make with what they have in their pantry right now
- Log in and credentialing to view your own personal set of recipes

2.3 Product Differences

Compared to existing systems, the Sous Chef recipe manager software offers a robust set of features aimed at enhancing user experience through advanced recipe management, collaboration, and planning tools. The inclusion of version control, detailed privacy settings, and the innovative "Pantry Meals" feature provides a comprehensive solution for users looking to manage their culinary endeavors more effectively. These capabilities make it a standout option in the recipe management software market.

3. Team Members

The Sued Chefs have three members with differing skill sets. Zac has experience C#, SQL databases especially PostgreSQL, Docker, and various web app development technologies. Aimee has familiarity with SQL databases as well as web technologies like Express and React. Andrew has experience performing query operations on JSON and in NoSQL environments.

We plan to work together in a flat management structure to collaborate and make the best recipe manager that we can throw together in six weeks or less! We will work together in multiple phases to first assemble the database, then the backend components, and then the frontend components of the software. Some overlap is possible and we may pivot as the situation develops.